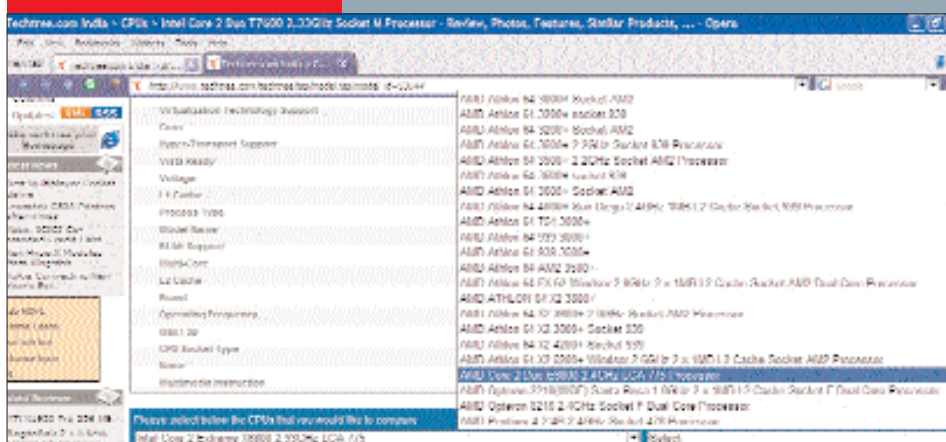


DigiPick of the month

"Where AMD meets Intel"



WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **"DigiPick"** and your postal address **on or before the 20th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

Last month's winner is

Ketan Gandhi, Alibag, Maharashtra

Participate and win next month

Excel Advanced Report development

by Timothy Zapqwa

Published by

WILEY-INDIA



following donates them enough money to do so.

Since 1967, Sealand has been run by Paddy Roy Bates—also known as Roy of Sealand—who has fiercely protected the sovereignty of his little nation, which has become an object of desire for computer geeks everywhere. It's the ideal place to carry out any activity without interference from any government, including hosting a warez server.

The fact that it's a salty-aired platform in the middle of the sea with uncertain means of obtaining electricity is hardly a deterrent, even. On January 15, The Pirate Bay announced that they had entered negotiations with the "government" of Sealand for the property.

However, the organisation's lofty

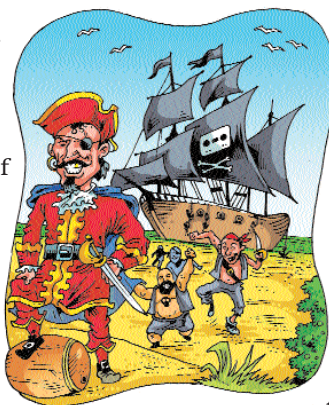
ambitions have been met with much ridicule, not to mention the fact that they've barely raised a fraction of the £504,000 that old Roy wants for the premises. Another snag is that the Sealanders don't want their homeland sold to anyone whose interests are against the UK, and this might bung a considerably large spanner in the machinery. Furthermore, the very sovereignty of the

nation is under question.

The Pirate Bay has a sneaky backup plan, though—if they don't manage to get enough money for Sealand, they'll still invest in an island somewhere and claim it their country.

Prices for islands start at \$50,000 these days, they tell us.

Sweden has always been a country with a healthy and socially acceptable file-sharing culture, and even if



The Pirate Bay remains on their soil, all they might have to worry about is annoying legal threats from assorted record and software companies—nothing new, really. In the meanwhile, several Digit members are contemplating shifting to the nation, not just for the files, but also for the *average* 1 Gbps bandwidth per person. Arrrrr.

I PHISH, YOU PHISH

DIY Phishing Kit Hits The Market

Want access to private information and credit card numbers, but can't code to save your life? Or are you just lazy? Whatever the answer, thanks to the Universal Man-in-the-middle Phishing Kit, you'll never have to worry again! You can buy the kit online (no, we're not going to tell you where—do your own dirty work), and "create a fraudulent URL via a simple and user-friendly

People Who Changed Computing

Clive "Specy" Sinclair

Sinclair was a British entrepreneur who invented the world's first "slim-line" calculator, the Anita 800. In 1972, this was the only



Sinclair

calculator that could be carried in a pocket. His biggest gift to the world was the ZX Spectrum

microcomputer; in 1982, it was the UK's first massively popular home computer.

The "Specy" was powerful and affordable. It was about the size of a doormat, and the black, sleek thing with rubber keys housed a Zilog Z80 processor running at 3.5 MHz, and 16 KB or 48 KB of RAM. The Spectrum used a regular TV for the display.

Due to the Spectrum's poor software, enthusiasts began to write their own, and that set the UK gaming industry into motion. Sinclair had hoped the mass-production of home computers would teach people about computers, but the Specy became primarily a gaming thing.

Sinclair wrote his first article titled "Practical Wireless" at school. He gave up studying after school and went on to sell miniature electronic kits to the hobbyist market. Some of his books—"Radio Constructor," "Modern Transistor Circuits for Beginners," and others became a hit in the 1960s. His most recent invention is a bicycle called "A-Bike"; it weighs just 5.5 kilograms and folds up!

The Spectrum never became a big hit in the US, but people over much of the world, including India, remember it with fondness.